

Yeoford Village Voice

Distributed free to homes in Yeoford and District, Devon

September 2025

Issue 413



Photo taken by Niki Jones

This month: No, you're not Hallucinating, it's a Toilet! The Park House! Quiz! Will Blake Band! Spiders! And much, much more...

Contact Details

LOCAL ORGANISATIONS/CLUBS ETC.

YEOFORD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

Chair: Ed Drake

Bookings: yeoford.hall@gmail.com 01363 84501

YEOFORD RECREATION GROUND

Warden: David Lucking 01363 84988

YEOFORD HOLY TRINITY CHURCH

Contact: Carol Price 01647 24468

YEOFORD PRIMARY SCHOOL

Contact: School Administrator 01363 84234

YEOFORD FOUNDATION STAGE UNIT

Contact: Administrator 01363 84234

YEOFORD CRICKET CLUB

Captain: Paul Coren 01363 84238

YEOFORD 200 C£UB

Contact: club200yeoford@outlook.com

CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL

Chairman: John Stevens 01363 773918

Clerk: Rachel Hodder 01363 85523

clerk@creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk

THE YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE TEAM

Editor:

Jonathan Rogers 01363 84501

yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk

Advertising:

Di Parsons 01363 84155

diparsons9876@gmail.com

Everything else:

David Lucking 01363 84988

USEFUL CONTACTS

POLICE

101 in a non-Emergency

999 in an Emergency

0800 555111 Crimestoppers

0800 405040 Transport Police

EMERGENCIES

105 Electricity Failure

0845 9881188 EA Floodline

0800 807060 Environment Hotline

0800 111999 Gas Emergency

0800 1691144 Water Leaks/Burst Mains

0845 1551004 Roads/Street Lights

0310 1234999 RSPCA

0845 6000388 Social Services

MEDICAL

01363 772227 Redlands Primary Carey

01647 24272 Cheriton Bishop Surgery

111 NHS Choices (non-Emergency)

01363 775588 Crediton Hospital

01363 772062 Boots Pharmacy

01363 773030 Crediton Pharmacy

01363 772841 Lloyds Pharmacy

C159X Yeoford Defibrillator Code

No Code Required Duck Defibrillator

SCHOOLS

01363 84234 Yeoford Primary

01363 773401 QE Academy Trust

OTHERS

01363 778410 Citizens Advice

0845 7484950 National Rail Enquiries

01363 85273 The Duck at Yeoford

01363 773303 Crediton Ring and Ride

COUNCILS/MP

0345 155 1015 Devon County Council

01884 255255 Mid Devon District Council

0207 2197037 Mel Stride MP

mel.stride.mp@parliament.uk

The Village Voice Really Needs You...

The Yeoford Village Voice relies on advertising and donations to ensure that it goes to press each month. To advertise in the Village Voice and reach over 600 people locally:

Monthly Charges

Full Page...£20 Half Page...£15

Quarter...£8 Eighth...£4

Please contact **Di** on

01363 84155 [diparsons9876@gmail.com] to discuss your requirements.

Editorial

Looking wet out there...

Well, there you go, Summer's done one and it's all downhill from here, unless we get a random pulse of decent weather, which has happened in the not too distant past. Maybe it'll rock up for Yeo!Cider like previously?!

Anyway, let's crack on with the talk of the village for August, which was the new public convenience on the way to Crediton. Oh the excitement for anyone caught short on that arduous 10-minute journey. A godsend for weary travellers who just needed a rest and a rather nice monument to the ceramic arts. There was an opening ceremony apparently as highlighted by a bottle of wine sitting next to it for a while. But just when it looked like BBC Spotlight were going to come down and do a feature on it, the blimmin' thing vanished. Absolute scenes.

On a potentially more permanent note, there's some rather exciting plans for a new community arts venue in Crediton, more details in here.

This month sees the Will Blake Band up at the Hall on Saturday 6th. This is run by Crediton Boniface Rotary and always has a good turnout. Ticket details inside. Moving into October, we have Yeo!Cider on Saturday 18th. Cider, beer, food, lots of music, games and a huge amount of fun expected as ever. Preparations have already begun and sponsors have started to sign-up. If you, or your employers, are interested in sponsoring, please get in touch via the Yeoford Hall email or Yeofest Facebook page. Likewise, if you're interested in volunteering on the day, please get in touch. That is all...

Cheers...

The Editor

The Village Voice Is YOUR Village Magazine

We want to hear from you and want you to use it to convey anything you feel of interest to your fellow villagers.

Please leave any items for the YVV at Torricon, Station Road before the **20th of each month**, anything after that date may not be considered until the following month. **You must provide a name and address**, even if this is not for publication.

You can also email the editor, Jonathan, at **yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk** or phone **01363 84501**

Publishing date: **the first week of each month.**

The Village Voice accepts no responsibility for any of the information or contributions contained herein.



Local Information

YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL

COMMUNITY HALL CHARGES (hourly rate)

	Trustee User Groups	Local Community Groups	Private Bookings (Local)	Private Bookings (Non Local)
Main Hall (includes kitchen)	£3.00	£5.00	£8.00	£10.00
Meeting Room (includes kitchen)	£2.00	£3.00	£3.50	£5.50
Party/Wedding 24hr hire	—	—	£150	£250
Party/Wedding 48hr hire	—	—	£400	£500

Exclusive field use, BBQ, Stage, Disco Equipment also available.

For bookings, please e-mail yeoford.hall@gmail.com
Or phone: 01363 84501

The latest hall calendar can be found at
www.yeoford.org/community-hall

SARAH'S BARBER SHOP

85 High Street, Crediton

Tel: 01363 899269 07772 336489

Walk-Ins:

Monday 9:00-17:00, Tuesday 9:00-16:30

Appointments:

Thursday 9:00-18:30, Friday 9:00-17:00,

Saturday 8:00-14:00

Wednesday CLOSED

Booking App: Nearcut

* Yeoford Community Garden *
* Yeoford Community Hall now has an area *
* dedicated to providing a small community *
* garden. Any villagers are welcome to get *
* involved in running and maintaining the *
* garden. *
* Please speak to **Dee Hawkins** or email *
* yeoford.hall@gmail.com for further *
* information. *

Top Tip!

Avoid spider season entirely by
turning your heating up full and
moving into your shed. Invade
THEIR houses, see how they like it.

PUNCHBOWL RECYCLING CENTRE

OPEN 7 DAYS A WEEK

MON-FRI: 09:00 - 17:00

SAT & SUN: 10:00 - 18:00

TRAINTIMES FROM YEOFORD

NB: Yeoford is a Request Stop

TO BARNSTAPLE

Mon Sat Sun
-Fri

0540
0630 0633
0725 0730
0834 0837
0937 0937 0938
1037 1037 1039
1137 1137 1138
1237 1238 1238
1337 1337 1335
1437 1438 1435
1537 1537 1536
1637 1637 1637
1738 1739 1736
1841 1844 1836
1943 1947 1938
2041 2043 2037
2147 2145

2313
Fo

TO EXETER

Mon Sat Sun
-Fri

0708 0713
0813 0816
0918 0921
1019 1018 1017
1117 1117 1117
1216 1216 1221
1319 1319 1317
1417 1417 1417
1516 1516 1519
1617 1617 1614
1719 1720 1718
1822 1825 1818
1924 1930 1917
2023 2026 2017
2124 2123 2119
2227 2224 2226
2320 2320
Fx
2352
Fo

Fx – Monday-Thursday
Fo – Friday only
For more details, go to
GWR.com/timetables



Bus Timetables

677 (Fridays only)

Dartline Coaches

Zeal Monachorum Church	0912
Coleford Gospel Hall	0927
Colebrooke Church	0932
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	0936
YEO VIEW	0938
Raddon Down Cross	0945
Crediton TIC High Street	0955
Exeter Sidwell Street	1020

Exeter Sidwell Street	1320
Crediton TIC High Street	1345
Raddon Down Cross	1350
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1355
YEO VIEW	1357
Colebrooke Church	1403
Coleford Gospel Hall	1408
Zeal Monachorum Church	1423

669 (Tuesdays only)

MD Buses

South Zeal Oxenham Arms	0915
Whiddon Down Shelter	0922
Hittisleigh Cross	0930
Crockernwell	0945
Cheriton Bishop School	0947
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1002
Colebrooke Church	1010
Coleford Gospel Hall	1013
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1022
Crediton Morrisons	1027

Crediton Morrisons	1115
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1235
Coleford Gospel Hall	1244
Colebrooke Church	1247
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1255
Cheriton Bishop School	1310
Crockernwell	1313
Hittisleigh Cross	1326
Whiddon Down Shelter	1328
South Zeal Oxenham Arms	1335

YEOFORD POST OFFICE

Friday 3:15-4:15pm in the Community Hall

Free Banking available for most Banks, Personal & Business. All Post Office Services. Post Office One4All Gift Cards. Currency. Mobile, Electric & Gas Top-Ups. Dry cleaning. Cards & Stationery items.

Contact: CHUDLEIGH POST OFFICE; TEL: 01626 852149



West Down Chapel Yeoford Road

Sunday 7th September Morning Worship at 11am
with Andrew and Kim Conlan.

Wednesday 9th September at 2pm Friend and
Neighbours come, and join the different things we
do with tea and biscuits.

Sunday 14th September Morning Worship at 11am
with Rev David Cole.

Sunday 21st September Morning Worship at 11am
John Allan.

Following the morning service it is Sunday lunch to
book contact Kate on 07772 239419, This is
followed by prayer Fellowship.

Sunday 28th September Morning Worship at 11am
with Peter Boddington.

Contacts:

David Pitts djpitts270@gmail.com
01363 773379

Derek Coren shortacombe@googlemail.com
01647 24264 / 07929858527

YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL—SEEKING COMMUNITY GROUPS!

Yeoford Community
Hall has availability
for community
groups for one-offs
or regular bookings
on Wednesday
evenings, Thursday
evenings or Sunday
evenings. Exercise
classes, craft groups,
workshops,
educational events
or social clubs would
be warmly
welcomed. Trial
periods will be
accommodated.

Daytime slots on
occasional Tuesdays
and Thursdays are
also available.

Saturday 6th September 2025 Yeoford Community Hall

From 7.15pm – 11.15pm
Tickets £15.00

Bar and Food Available Cash/Card Reader
In aid of Crediton Boniface
Rotary Local Charities

Tickets available from

Nick Yarnold 01363 84536 or 07833 091500



YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE FUN QUIZ

No prizes, no pressure...this month...September...

1. The Anglo-Saxons called the month Gerstmonath, after which crop usually harvested in September which they used to make beer?
2. September's birthstone is which precious gemstone, a variety of the mineral corundum?
3. In 1752, September had only 19 days in the UK as which calendar was changed to the Gregorian calendar?
4. Which world famous festival, held annually in Munich, Germany, is a folk festival running from mid- or late September to the first Sunday in October?
5. The birth of Queen Elizabeth I happened on 17 September, 1533, can you name her mother?
6. What did Robbie Williams switch on in 2010, the Bee Gees in 1995, and Red Rum in 1977?
7. Which American said: "My favourite poem is the one that starts 'Thirty days hath September' because it actually tells you something."?
8. Which British Prime Minister exclaimed on the 30 September, 1938, "I believe it is peace for our time"?
9. On the 13th of September 1902, Harry Jackson became the first person in Britain convicted on what sort of evidence?
10. Every September the Egremont Crab Fair in Cumbria is home to which face pulling competition?

Answers below...

Quiz Answers:
1. Barley; 2. Sapphire; 3. Julian; 4. The Oktoberfest; 5. Anne Boleyn; 6. Blackpool illuminations (always annually switched on in September); 7. Groucho Marx; 8. Neville Chamberlain; 9. Fingerprint evidence; 10. The Gurning World Championships

Library at the Church

Following the demise of the Mobile Library, alongside the books at the station, there is also now a small library in Yeoford Church and all are welcome to borrow books.

FROM THE PARISH COUNCIL

REPORTING A PROBLEM WITH ROADS TO DEVON COUNTY COUNCIL

All drivers will be aware that state of repair of roads in Crediton Hamlets Parish is appalling, with more and more potholes (or are they craters?) appearing. The lack of action by Devon County Council is exceedingly frustrating but please report potholes in the hope this makes a difference.

Problems with roads can be reported on the Devon County Council website:
www.devon.gov.uk/roads-and-transport/report-a-problem/

There is a link to this page under "Useful Information" on the Parish Council website
www.creditonhamlets.org.uk.

If the pothole has already been reported please add yourself to the existing report so that Devon County Council is aware that another person has reported the problem.



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Coffee
morning
at
Crediton
Mole

u3a
learn, laugh, live

Avon will be on **Tuesday
16th at 10.30am.**

Open meeting at the
Boniface Centre on
**Wednesday 17th at
10am when Martin
Pailthorpe will talk about
Filming wildlife in the
Celtic Fringe. All are
welcome.**

'Move, Stretch & Smile'

NEW WEEKLY 'YEOFORD CHAIR YOGA' for Over 65s!

Feel Stronger, Happier & More Balanced in

YEOFORD HALL beginning @ 10.10AM – 10.55AM on TUESDAY OCTOBER 7TH

Join local esmeyoga, with 25 years of experience, for fun, gentle sessions for over 65's. These classes offer safe, accessible movements boosting flexibility, balance, circulation, mobility, energy & overall wellbeing—and from the comfort of a chair!

No yoga experience is required & EVERYONE is welcome. All you need is comfortable clothing, a smile, & the willingness to join in. Come along, move at your own pace, enjoy the benefits of yoga in a friendly, supportive group & feel the difference in both body & mind.

Contact Esme for more details, or reserve your spot:

07880 790 341 [info @esmeyoga.co.uk](mailto:info@esmeyoga.co.uk) www.esmeyoga.co.uk



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Andy Colquhoun

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or: 01363 85460

Email: lindenleagardens@gmail.com

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mowing

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Tractor driving

Small holder land management etc.

Call or e-mail now to see how Clive
can assist!

07523 907651

busterandclive@gmail.com

Crediton Arts Centre News

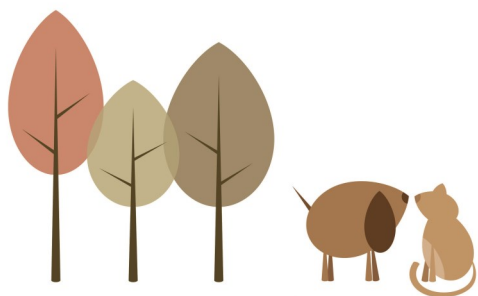
4 September:
Jazz on the Green

15 September:
Jazz on the Green special

19 September:
Moon Jazz

Check the website for more
details

www.creditonartscentre.org



**Orchard End
Kennels & Cattery**

Black dog, Crediton, EX17 4QE

01363 877371

www.orchardendkennels.co.uk

Holy Trinity Church Yeoford

We are getting back to normal in September
after the summer break from Café Company
and Lunch Club.

As we have suspended Messy Church for a
short while we are inviting all families to our
Family Service on the 4th Sunday of the
month. It is run very much on the lines of
Messy Church with a craft and family friendly
worship, with coffee / tea / squash and cake or
biscuits served before the service at 11am.

Café Company Mondays from 10 till 11am
except when there is Lunch Club.

Lunch Club will resume on September 1st 12-
15 for 12-30pm.

Services in September
Sunday 14th September
Holy Communion 9-30 am

Sunday 28th September
Family Service 11-15am
We will be serving refreshments from 11am



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JOKE OF THE MONTH COMPETITION

I asked my dog
what is two
minus two.

He said nothing.

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monika@reignsupremeuk.com**



01392 648 191

Address : The Seante, Southernhay Gardens, Exeter
Email: getintouch@reignsupremeuk.com

Regular Local Music Events

Summer'25 All participatory events, free unless mentioned



Every Tues 7.15 - 8.45pm Crediton Strummers, Crediton Arts Centre. £2.50
Any instrument, at any level. Music/words provided. Ed Finch 07810 861917

1st Tues of month 8pm Sandford folk session, The Lamb Inn, main bar. Mainly song.

Last Tues 8pm Folk session, New Inn, Coleford. Mainly song.

Every Wed 7.30pm CODS Crediton Operatic Society, Old Town Hall.
Put on regular plays, musicals and concerts. www.codsonline.com

2nd Wed 7.30pm Open mic, The White Hart, North Tawton

Every Thurs 7.30pm Acoustic night, Lapford Mill. Anything goes! Great intimate venue.

1st Thurs 12 - 3pm and 3rd Thurs 7.30pm
Folk session, Pennymoor Singaround. London Inn, Morchard Bishop. Mainly song.

3rd Thurs 7.30pm Jazz Club, Three Pigs £5 House band but anyone can play/sing/jam

1st Friday 6-9pm Open mic, Turning Tides, Crediton Station Tea Rooms. Hot/soft drinks.

2nd Friday 7pm Night Train open mic. Elephant on the Green cafe. Bar and nice vibes.

4th Fri 7pm Open mic, Cafe 100, Crediton High St. Friendly and diverse, bar available.

Red Deer pub, near big Tesco. 2nd Sun 7-10pm Blues Jam. 3rd Sun Jazz night 7-10pm
Last Sun 7-10pm The Great Crediton Music Night. Jam with house band or solo spots.

Last Sun 12-3pm Folk music Half Moon Inn, Cheriton Fitzpaine. Musicians/listeners



Contact Hazel with updates
sagalout1@gmail.com

YEOFORD

Community Hall Cider Festival
PRESENTS

YEO!CiDER '25

SATURDAY 18TH OCTOBER 2025
From 12:00 at Yeoford Community Hall

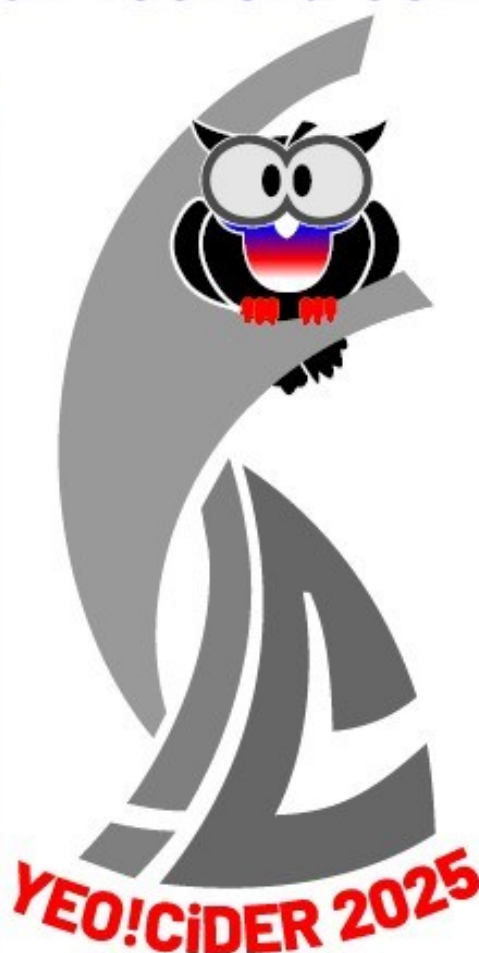
YEO!CiDER: 14



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PROGRAMME



LIVE MUSIC,
GAMES &
FOOD



Yeoford Community Hall
Yeo View
Yeoford EX17 5HY
/// mats.crank.flagged

YEO!CiDER: 14



16+ CIDERS
& PERRIES



y!C'25

TRAINS TO & FROM
YEOFORD STATION

Exeter St Davids	1119	1219	1319	1419	1520	1619	1720	1824
Crediton	1131	1232	1331	1432	1531	1631	1733	1838
Barnstaple	1035	1135	1232	1335	1435	1535	1639	1736
Exeter/Crediton	1417	1516	1617	1720	1825	1930	2026	2123
Barnstaple	1438	1537	1637	1739	1844	1947	2043	2145

***ALL PROCEEDS GO TO YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL**

The Park House - a new venue in the heart of Crediton

What do you think?

The Crediton Heart Project has some exciting plans to develop a community arts venue on the edge of Newcombes Meadow and we want to know what you think. The Park House would include a flexible performance space, with seating for 300, rooms for other community activities and a beautiful café opening onto the park. It would provide a welcoming and inclusive place to meet, learn and create together in the heart of our town



Built on the site of the dilapidated Union Road toilet block, between the War Memorial and Bike Shed, the Park House could offer amazing opportunities for local and national performance groups and bring many more events to our area, including theatre, cinema, dance, comedy and live music. It would transform our park and regenerate our town centre.

Crediton and its surrounding villages are important and vibrant communities in Mid Devon. But Crediton is expanding and to avoid it becoming a dormitory town for Exeter, we need to provide the spaces and facilities to ensure that people can choose to spend their leisure time locally and that our community continues to thrive.

The project is being led by the Crediton Heart Project, with support from Crediton Town Council and Mid Devon District Council. The Heart Project is a volunteer led charity, set up in 2018 with the key aim of developing a new community venue. Since then we have been exploring possible sites and running a range of successful projects such as the Crediton Heart Project community website, an annual Summer Arts Festival and, most recently, the Kick Start Art project for children.



Last year the Newcombes Meadow site became available so we commissioned a feasibility study by award winning theatre designers, Foster Wilson Size. They concluded the site could accommodate a 300-seat professionally equipped theatre suitable for a wide range of performances and events. The Park House hasn't been designed yet, but this is a computer generated image of what it could look like.

This is a hugely ambitious project with the potential to benefit everyone in our community. But before we take the next steps we need to know what people in the town and surrounding villages think. We would be very grateful if you could share your views by completing a short online survey available via this QR code or our website www.creditonheartproject.org

Paper copies of this survey are also available at Crediton Library and Crediton Town Council. Thank you.



Yeo Ward Newsletter – Summer 2025

A Positive Month for Mid Devon

Mid Devon has been nationally praised for cutting costs while boosting services and green initiatives (Devon Live, 29 July). Some highlights include:

- **Leisure Success** – Active Mid Devon membership has hit a record 7,000 while costs have been reduced by £540,000.
- **Improved Services** – Resident satisfaction with local services has risen to 52% (+11%).
- **Better Communication** – 60% of residents now feel well-informed (+15%).
- **Housing** – Tenant satisfaction remains high at 70%.
- **Greener & Growing** – Environmental projects and economic development are moving forward across the district.

Health & Wellbeing

- Trial **Wellbeing Walks** have begun in Crediton, Cullompton and Tiverton – building confidence for volunteers to lead local walks.
- **Junior Park Runs** have been approved, with funding bids underway.

Planning Updates

- The **Planning & Infrastructure Bill** will change how planning decisions are made. Most small-scale applications will never go to committee, while larger developments may require head of planning and chair approval.
Mid Devon must show a **5-year housing land supply**. With our Local Plan expiring in July 2025, failure to update could weaken control over development (“Tilted Balance”).

Community & Local Issues

- Plans are underway to remodel the **Willand Waste Depot** (£1.7m) to boost recycling capacity for at least 15 years.
- The **Nature Recovery Strategy** will soon be out for consultation – mapping local habitats and biodiversity priorities.

Cllr Sandy Chenore

- Vice Chair of **Mid Devon District Council**
 - Member of **Homes PDG**
 - Member of **Community, People & Environment PDG**
- e schenore@middevon.gov.uk

I’m here to represent Yeo ward residents and raise your concerns at Council level. Please do get in touch with any issues.

Autumn Fair

Saturday 20th September

2.30 pm

St Andrews Church

Hittisleigh

Cakes – Preserves

Craft items for sale

Stalls, Games

Raffle

Teas in marquee

ESMEYOGA

'5 ELEMENT' YOGA CLASS SCHEDULE

Enjoy fun, seasonal flow classes catering to all!

Stretch & strengthen your body, develop
balance & learn breath-work to slow &
calm a busy mind.

TUESDAYS

@YEOFORD HALL: 9.15AM - 10.15AM

@CREDITON MUSEUM: 6PM - 7PM

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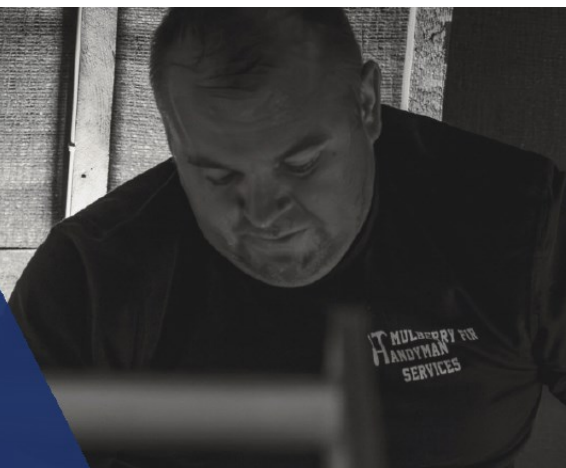
Ricky: 07712177710



Stefan from MULBERRY FIR
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- ✓ Shower doors & trays installation
- ✓ Small carpentry jobs
- ✓ Fencing
- ✓ Room wall panelling
- ✓ Odd jobs around the house

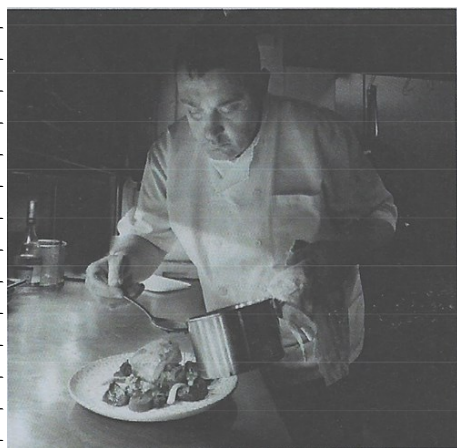
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Gordon Ramsay's loss is our gain!



The name James Parkinson possibly doesn't ring a bell but The Duck at Yeoford probably does. That's because James is usually hidden in the kitchen, cooking those delicious meals we enjoy in his pub. So who is James?

Growing up in Lincolnshire, James had no interest in cooking, but then his granny was a chef so maybe it was in his blood. At the age of 16 he left school to take up a cheffing apprenticeship in a hotel in the next village and he was soon hooked. After 18 months the Head Chef there opened a bakery in Cleethorpes and took James with him. The baking side started at 4am each day but cheffing was James' passion so he also worked at a local restaurant in the evenings.

After a year, he joined a friend at Hunstrete House in Bath, where he got the taste for working in country house fine dining establishments and remained for two and a half years.

In 1993, he went to work for a young chef called Gordon Ramsay at 'Aubergine' in Chelsea. It was a steep learning curve cooking for celebrities and coping with Gordon's idiosyncrasies. After a year, James had had enough so he applied for posts at Hambleton Hall in Oakham and Hartwell House in Aylesbury. He was offered both posts. When Ramsay heard, he contacted both places and rubbished James' reputation - something he was known for doing when an employee decided to move. Hambleton Hall withdrew their offer but Hartwell House said they would take James at face value. Hartwell House clearly didn't share Ramsay's opinion because James had two happy years there before moving to the 2* Michelin/ 4 Rosettes Gordleton Mill in the New Forest working for celebrity chef Jean Christophe Novelli. After a further two years with John Burton-Race at L'Ortolan in Reading as Sous Chef, James felt it was time to look for a Head Chef position.

He found one at Congham Hall in Kings Lynn; the year was 1999 and he was about to embark on a long career working for Andrew Davis of the Von Essen Group. Over the years, James watched the empire grow to 33 hotels and became Executive Chef of the Von Essen Group; touring those establishments, writing menus, meeting suppliers, recruiting their chefs, and ensuring they retained their Rosette standards.

In 2003, Von Essen bought Lewtrenchard Manor in Devon and added it to their portfolio. It is also where James met his wife Sarah, who was managing Lewtrenchard. In 2006, they married and moved to Tetbury, where Sarah became a hotel inspector, they started a family, and James continued working with Von Essen. When Von Essen collapsed in 2011, Patron Capital acquired 30% of Von Essen and James continued to work with the Luxury Family Hotels Group.

In 2010, Sarah and James moved to Morchard Bishop to be nearer to Sarah's parents and in March 2019 they bought The Duck at Yeoford - exactly a year before Covid struck. By providing takeaways and opening the Pub Up Shop, James and Sarah came through Covid. In fact the sidelines went so well they retained the takeaway service and shop as well as running their hugely popular pub, where James' excellent cooking draws in the punters. Eat your heart out Gordon Ramsay!



James with former Aubergine colleague Marcus Wareing, who came to dinner at The Duck a few years ago

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Oak Tree Skips

Mid Devon

01363 884284

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